1.5 How computers can help

In this lesson

You will learn:

➔ what kinds of tasks computers can help us do.

What can computers do?

Mrs Harb is a teacher. She uses a computer to help with her work.



What tasks can people do by using a computer?

- Jobs where the same task is repeated over and over again, or needs to be done very carefully
- Work out hard mathematics very quickly
- Share information with lots of people all at once.



In the picture, computers are used to build cars.

Activity

Look at this picture.



Which jobs in the picture could a computer do? Which activities in the picture could a computer do? Write down your answers like this:

A computer can work out how much to charge for food.

Extra challenge

Can you think of any other everyday activities a computer could do?

Explore more

Is using a computer always the best way to carry out a task? Talk with an adult about tasks that humans do better than computers.

1.6 When computers can't help

In this lesson

You will learn:

- what kinds of tasks computers cannot do easily.

What can humans do better than computers?

Humans can carry out many tasks.



Humans are better than computers at:

- understanding other people
- art and creativity
- inventing new ways to do things.

Activity

These girls are doing a dance. They do not want a computer to do that task. They enjoy dancing themselves.

Think of another task that humans enjoy doing. Could computers do this task instead?

Extra challenge

In a care home, old people are looked after by kind nurses. How can a computer help the nurses? What tasks are better for the nurses to do themselves?



Digital citizen of the future

Cars have been invented that can drive by themselves. They have a computer inside. Perhaps in the future nobody will drive a car. Think about the advantages and disadvantages of this. Do you want to learn to drive when you are older?

Think again

Give one reason why we might decide not to use a computer to help with a task.